

LESSON 115 (0.5 GROUND and 1.5 DUAL)

Lesson Objective

During this lesson, the applicant will be introduced to the traffic pattern, including landings. This should combine a variety of the skills learned in the previous lessons. The applicant should have a proper pattern demonstrated to them and they should also become aware of all safety related elements pertinent to the pattern. The applicant should be able to make radio calls with little instructor guidance.

Briefing

- Outline the objectives and completion standards of the lesson.
- Establish the student and instructor responsibilities.
- Review homework assigned in the previous lesson.
 - Ask the students if they have any questions on the procedures from the maneuver's manual.
 - Traffic Pattern.
 - Normal and Crosswind Takeoffs.
 - Go-Arounds and Rejected Landings.
 - Normal and Crosswind Landings.
 - Have the student draw out a traffic pattern to the best of their understanding.
 - Quiz the student on the reading from the Airplane Flying Handbook as needed.
- Student questions.

References

- Advisory Circular. ([Search Tool](#))
 - Stall and Spin Awareness Training. ([AC 61-67](#))
- Airplane Flying Handbook. ([FAA-H-8083-3C](#))
 - Chapter 05 - Maintaining Aircraft Control: Upset Prevention and Recovery Training.
 - Chapter 08 - Airport Traffic Patterns.
 - Chapter 09 - Approaches and Landings.
- Warrior Maneuvers Manual.

Instructor guidance

- This is the student's first introduction to the traffic pattern and landings — one of the most challenging and anticipated milestones in primary training. Set clear expectations during the pre-brief: the goal today is pattern familiarity and exposure to the landing sequence, not perfection. Managing expectations early prevents frustration and keeps the student engaged.
- Before departing, have the student draw out a complete traffic pattern from memory, including power settings, airspeeds, and radio calls for each leg. A student who cannot do this on the ground will be overwhelmed in the air. Address any gaps before the flight.
- Demonstrate at least one full traffic pattern yourself before handing over control. Narrate every action — power reductions, flap selections, sight pictures, crosswind corrections — so the student builds a clear mental model of what the pattern looks and feels like before they attempt it.

- Landings are among the most difficult skills to teach and learn in aviation. Be patient and give the student time to develop their own sight picture and feel for the round out and flare. Expect to provide significant guidance during the flare on early attempts — this is normal and expected at this stage.
- Require at least one deliberate go-around during the lesson. The go-around must be treated as a normal, positive decision — not a failure. Students who develop hesitation around go-arounds carry that hesitation into solo operations and beyond. Reinforce the procedure: power first, then flap retraction in stages, then trim.
- Crosswind correction must be maintained through and after touchdown. Many students relax their inputs the moment the wheels touch — address this immediately whenever it occurs and explain the directional control consequences.
- Radio calls in the pattern are a significant workload addition for the student. Assist as needed, but gradually reduce your input with each lap so the student is building independence. By the end of the lesson they should be making calls with little to no prompting.
- Keep a sharp eye on traffic throughout the entire lesson. Pattern operations at a towered airport involve significant traffic awareness responsibilities. Actively scan and call out traffic to the student — model the habit of continuous looking, not just looking when ATC calls traffic.
- During the post-brief, focus the student self-critique specifically on their approach stability and flare timing. These are the two areas they will need to improve most rapidly heading into the next several lessons.

Lesson Content (Ground)

Normal and Crosswind Takeoffs

- Review the procedure from the maneuver's manual.
- Emphasize the importance of using rudder as necessary to maintain directional control.
- Discuss the effect of wind on takeoff and crosswind correction.
- Discuss the climb checklist.

Traffic Patterns

- Draw and label the basic structure for a standard traffic pattern.
 - Power settings.
 - Airspeeds.
 - Non-specific vs specific aiming points.
- Explain the differences between standard and non-standard traffic patterns.
 - Direction of turns.
 - Altitudes.
 - Shape. (noise abatement procedures, high volume traffic)
- Entry and Departures.
 - Towered vs non-towered airports.

Stabilized Approach

- Ask the student what a stabilized approach is.
 - Consistent and safe glide path.

- Appropriate airspeeds.
- Follows an extended centerline down to the runway.
- An unstable approach must result in a go-around.

Stall/Spin Awareness

- Ask the student about aircraft upset.
- Ask the student to describe in general terms how a stall might occur, and how to correct for it.
- The student should be able to define what a spin is and in which phase of flight a spin might occur.

Go-arounds and Rejected Landings

- Review go-around procedures.
 - Emphasize the importance of not going directly to flaps 0.
 - Emphasize the importance of adding power first.
 - Emphasize the use of TRIM.

Normal and Crosswind Landings

- Review the procedure from the maneuver's manual.
- Introduce sight pictures and other visual cues as needed.
- Discuss the effect of wind and crosswind correction.

Go/No-Go Decision

- The student must make a go/no-go decision depending on:
 - Personal minimums.
 - FIT minimums.
 - Aircraft.
 - Airspace.
- Review the students planning with a focus on:
 - Weather, weight and balance, performance, flight planning, and fuel calculations.
 - NOTAMs, TFRs, FIFs, aircraft documents, and personal documents.
 - Equipment requirements (e.g. flashlight, fuel card, drinking water, view-limiting devices, life jackets, fly away kit, survival kit, etc.)
 - FRAT/TEM/safety considerations for the flight.
- While this is represented by one line item prior to departure, the go/ no-go decision is continuous and should be a consideration even once airborne.

Lesson Content (Dual)

Checklist Procedures

- Re-emphasize the importance of using checklists.
- Have the student run through all the checklists.
- Student should be able to perform all briefings.

Preflight Inspection

- Ensure that the student conducted a thorough preflight inspection.

Operation of the Communications and Navigation Units

- Ensure that the student understands how to properly use COMS and NAV units.

Radio Communication Procedures and ATC Phraseology

- The student should be able to conduct radio calls in towered airport.
- The students should be able to conduct radio calls in the practice area.
- The instructor should assist as needed.

Visual Scanning and Collision Avoidance

- Emphasize that it is the pilot in command's responsibility to avoid traffic.
- IF YOU SEE SOMETHING, SAY SOMETHING!

Review Previous Exercises as required

- Use the appropriate lesson plan depending on what needs to be reviewed.

Traffic Patterns

- The student should establish and execute a proper traffic pattern with instructor guidance.
- It will likely still be necessary for the instructor to provide guidance during the round out and flare portions.

Normal/Crosswind Takeoff

- The student should conduct the takeoff.
- Ensure the runway entry check and the lineup check are completed.
- Ensure proper crosswind correction is maintained.
- Ensure the student uses TRIM for desired airspeeds.
- Ensure the climb checklist is completed.

Go-around/Rejected Landing

- Have the student conduct a go-around during one of the traffic patterns.
- Ensure that the correct procedure is conducted.

Normal/Crosswind Landing

- The student should conduct the landing.
- Provide guidance during the round and flare.
- Provide guidance on proper crosswind correction.
 - Emphasize that this must be maintained even after touchdown.

Postflight Procedures

- Ensure that the student conducts a thorough postflight inspection.

Post-Brief

- Student self-critique.
- Instructor critique.
- Questions from the student.
- Lesson grading.

- Logbook completion.
- Schedule the next lesson.
- Preview the next lesson → 116.
- Assign homework:
 - Federal Aviation Regulations (FARs):
 - Part 61
 - Part 91
 - Review the Pilot's Handbook of Aeronautical Knowledge:
 - Chapter 15 - Airspace.

Completion Standards

This lesson is complete when the applicant can:

1. Demonstrate proper sequential checklist procedures for all normal procedures without instructor guidance.
2. Correctly perform previously learned maneuvers with minimal instructor guidance.
3. Conduct takeoffs with little instructor guidance.
4. Conduct traffic patterns and stabilized approaches with instructor guidance.
5. Make radio calls with little instructor guidance.